



Delaware County Council Meeting April 27th 2021

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=likA8DR2la8
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Delaware County Council Meeting Summary

Meeting Date: April 27, 2021

Body: Delaware County Council

2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** Presiding officer called the April 2021 legislative meeting of the Delaware County Council to order at [00:00:00](#) on April 27, 2021.
- **Attendance:**
 - Members present included Mr. Ballard, Mr. Chambers, Mr. Lasseter, Mr. Piper, Mr. Quakenbush (also spelled Quake and Bush), Mr. Webb, and Mr. Alexander.
 - Presiding officer: Led by Council leadership (explicitly referenced as presiding/running the meeting).

3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** The meeting opened with the recitation of the Pledge of Allegiance [00:00:32](#).
- **Approval of Agenda:** The updated agenda was approved via roll call vote following a motion by Mr. Piper and a second by Mr. Lasseter [00:01:38](#).

- **Approval of Minutes:** The March meeting minutes were approved following a motion by Mr. Piper and a second by Mr. Webb (00:03:06, roll call vote).
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4. Substantive Business & Board Action

- **00:04:05 Circuit Court Transfers & Equipment Requests**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Court Administrator / Circuit Court representative.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** The court requested a transfer of funds (moving extra salary money) to cover a \$3,500 safety repair for a secure door switching to a key box system. Additional funds addressed a \$1,400 shortage on computer replacements due to pandemic price increases, purchases of doorbell-style buzzers for jury alerts, acoustic tiles for zoom-ready video courtrooms in the jail, and COVID-related items eligible for reimbursement.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote (Motion: Piper, Second: Lasseter 00:04:52).
- **00:09:53 911 Communications Budget & Overtime Transfers**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** 911 Director.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Transfer of funds from various communication lines into the overtime budget to address staffing gaps and retention issues. The director noted that training takes roughly three months, though recent hires include an experienced transfer from another county and a military veteran with air traffic control experience. Recruitment pipeline discussions with Ivy Tech and local schools were noted.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote (Motion: Piper, Second: Lasseter 00:10:29).
- **00:15:26 Public Defender Transfer**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Public Defender Office Administrator.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Transfer of funds to replace a deputy public defender who left for another county.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote (Motion: Piper, Second: Lasseter 00:15:36).
- **00:16:38 Jail Correction Officer Line Transfers**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Jail Administration / Sheriff's Department.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Several adjustments among correctional officer lines accounting for resignations. It was noted that newer hires sometimes leave quickly for higher-paying positions in smaller nearby counties (e.g., Blackford County offering higher pay for fewer inmates). (Note: A corporal line adjustment was clarified to apply strictly to correctional officers rather than promotions 00:18:11).
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote (Motion: Piper, Second: Webb 00:19:45).

- **00:17:50 Additional Routine Personnel Line Transfers**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Various department heads / County Council.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** A series of administrative line-item transfers for the jail, public defender, election commissioner (00:13:14), and sheriff's department (00:23:56). A large 911 communications center transfer totaling \$795,000 was formally withdrawn on the record 00:24:44.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Respectively approved via individual roll call votes.
- **00:15:11 Prosecutor PCA Fund - Computer Equipment Purchase**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Prosecutor's Office / Laurie.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Request to use PCA funds (funds not scheduled to be spent for four years) to replace 10-year-old computers and software (MS Office 2019, wireless combos) for the support division. The project is 66% reimbursable. Total request: \$21,972.86.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote (Motion: Piper, Second: Quakenbush 00:25:43).
- **00:26:47 County Highway / Bridge Payroll Position**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Carrie D. (County Highway).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Request for \$17,331 for a payroll position split evenly between highway and bridge funds. The highway portion was approved in January; this action covers the bridge fund portion due to a budget glitch.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote (Motion: Piper, Second: Webb 00:26:56).
- **00:27:45 MVH Restricted - Contractual Services (Road Paving)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** County Highway representative.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Request for \$134,152.06 for contracted road work under the commissioners' 5-year plan. Paving locations for the current year include North Toronto, Demingate, Santa Barbara, and West of Costa.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote (Motion: Quakenbush, Second: Piper 00:27:55).
- **00:30:03 Surveyor Corner Perpetuation Fund Professional Services**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** County Surveyor's Office.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Request for \$30,000 in professional services from the corner perpetuation fund.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote (Motion: Piper, Second: Quakenbush 00:30:15).
- **00:31:03 Salary Ordinance Amendment (Lateral Transfers / Public Safety)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Council / Scott / 911 Committee.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Discussion and review of an amendment to the salary and hiring ordinance (Ordinance 2020-2015 / amending 2017 ordinance rules). The change allows qualified public safety and 911 communication lateral transfers from

other entities to start at 100% pay rather than being docked to a 90% probationary/starting rate, aiding competitiveness in retention and recruitment.

- **Action & Vote Disposition:**
 - Rules suspended by roll call vote (Motion: Piper, Second: Quakenbush 00:35:10).
 - Ordinance amended and approved by roll call vote (Motion: Piper, Second: Webb 00:34:50).
- 00:00:00 **Resolutions 2021-007 & 2021-008 (Temporary Fund Transfers)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Donna (Auditor).
 - **Deliberation Summary:**
 - **Resolution 2021-007:** Authorizing a temporary transfer from the Local Income Tax (LIT) tax relief fund to the county general fund 00:07:10.
 - **Resolution 2021-008:** Authorizing a temporary transfer from the Rainy Day Fund to the county general fund 00:48:48.
 - The Auditor noted these are precautionary measures in case borrowing is needed ahead of tax draws, though spring revenue currently looks stable. The history of the Rainy Day Fund (originated from county home sales and charitable/ambulance allocations) was also discussed.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Both resolutions Approved by roll call vote (Resolution 7 motion: Piper, second: Land 00:27:21; Resolution 8 motion: Piper, second: Webb 00:48:59).

5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

(Note: Formal public comment was restricted due to ongoing emergency orders/social distancing protocols, leading to procedural protests from the floor near the end of the meeting).

- 10:01:03 **Unnamed Citizen (via Facebook):** Inquired regarding the \$22 million allocated to Delaware County from the American Rescue Plan, asking if a committee had been formed to manage and approve expenditures. Council and Auditor representatives responded that while guidance is being reviewed and funds must be methodically planned, all expenditures will ultimately require County Council approval. - 01:10:31 **Unnamed Resident:** Objected to continued restrictions on in-person public input, noting that other local bodies (city council, county commissioners) were permitting open public attendance and comment, and requested the removal of meeting restrictions. Presiding officers maintained that the county remained under emergency social distancing orders, resulting in a brief procedural exchange before the meeting concluded.

6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:**

- **Budget Hearings:** Approved official budget hearing dates for the upcoming cycle, starting with public hearings on Wednesday, September 8, 2021, at 8:30 AM, and budget adoption scheduled for Tuesday, October 12, 2021, at 9:00 AM (Motion: Piper, Second: Quakenbush [00:59:28](#)).
- **Courtroom Accessibility:** Court administration received informal consensus approval to order five specialized witness chairs (\$485.10 each; total \$2,425.95) to resolve sightline issues caused by high witness box walls in courtrooms, pending a formal transfer next month [00:50:16](#).
- **Upcoming Meetings:** Notice given for a 9-1-1 Board meeting via Zoom on Thursday the 29th at 4:00 PM [10:52:50](#). District AIC virtual meetings were also noted.
- **Adjournment:** The meeting was officially adjourned following a motion by Mr. Piper and a second by Mr. Quakenbush, with disposition recorded via roll call vote [01:12:56](#).

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